Benefit Identification Card (BIC) Issuance	Number	Page
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Revision Date:
January 1, 2026

Background:
Providers use the BIC to verify eligibility and enter a share of cost (SOC) payment/obligation using the California Automated Eligibility Verification System (AEVS).

Purpose:
This section provides guidance on the issuance of BIC cards. This section has been reformatted as part of sunset review. There are no policy changes.

Policy:
The Department of Health Care Services (DHCS) issues plastic BIC cards to all Medi-Cal customers. Family Resource Centers (FRCs) may issue temporary BIC for Immediate Medical Need (IMN) or minor consent services.

A. BICs Issued by DHCS
DHCS issues BICs daily based on the Medi-Cal Eligibility Data System (MEDS) information. BICs are generated and mailed within 10 days from when a Medi-Cal customer is added to MEDS or when a replacement is requested. A new BIC is not needed when a customer reapplies after benefits are terminated or transitions between Medi-Cal programs.

BICs are issued to each:
- Eligible Medi-Cal Family Budget Unit (MFBU) member of an active Medi-Cal case
- Ineligible (IE) member
- Responsible Relative (RR)
- Supplemental Security Income/State Supplemental Program (SSI/SSP) eligible as reported by the Social Security Administration (SSA)
- Determined eligible to:
  - CalWORKs
  - Refugee Cash Assistance (RCA)
  - Foster Care (for instructions on issuance, refer to Medi-Cal Program Guide [MPG] 05.11.04)
  - Medi-Cal

Note: If the data in MEDS is incomplete or conflicting, a BIC will not be generated until the data is corrected.

B. Temporary BICs Issued at the FRC
County-issued temporary BICs are used for minor consent services and IMN. Providers can use this card to verify eligibility and bill for services for up to one year for minor consent services, and 30 days for IMN. This eliminates the need to issue additional cards for any subsequent month, unless the card is lost, stolen, or damaged.

C. When to issue a temporary BIC
FRCs will issue a temporary BIC when:

- An SSI/SSP customer requests one
- A customer has been determined to be eligible for Medi-Cal and has an IMN per MPG 04.05. An IMN BIC can be issued for eligible retroactive months
- The original BIC has not been received or the information on the card is incorrect
- A BIC was issued, but has been lost, stolen, or damaged

Note: Providers are not able to enter a SOC payment/obligation for newly approved customers that have a SOC until the day after they have been added to MEDS. Until then, the temporary BIC will verify eligibility only. If the customer needs to use the BIC the same day it is issued, the provider may note the customer's Client Identification Number (CIN), date of birth, BIC issuance date, and enter the SOC payment/obligation the following day.

Refer to Processing Guide 21 - Benefits Identification Card (BIC) Issuance for instructions on issuing the temporary BIC.

D. Minor Consent Services BICs

Minor consent services temporary BICs are always generated at the FRCs.

Confidentiality

To assure confidentiality for minor consent customers, MEDS requires that all minor consent temporary BICs be issued by an online transaction on a MEDS terminal using pseudo numbers rather than the Social Security Number (SSN). This means a minor consent case cannot be granted ongoing eligibility in MEDS. An online issuance must be completed every month that a minor consent services BIC is needed, which will then update the MEDS eligibility history file.

Note: Do not submit the minor's home address to DHCS via MEDS. Use the FRC P.O. Box to ensure that the minor consent customer does not receive a Beneficiary Explanation of Medi-Cal Benefits and Services or other mailings from DHCS.

Minor Consent Services Codes

Customers applying for minor consent services must specify the type of services they need covered before eligibility can be determined. For program evaluation and control purposes, DHCS has assigned each type of minor consent service a separate aid code. Enter these codes on the temporary BICs issued by the MEDS system. The codes will appear as part of the 14-digit county ID number in positions three and four, immediately following the county code. Indicate the aid code on the Request for Medi-Cal Temporary ID Card form (14-1 HHSA). Refer to MPG 04.04.01G for a list of minor consent aid codes.

Note: Do not use the minor consent services aid codes for minors who are already included in a public assistance case on a MFBU with zero SOC, or for minors who apply for and receive CalWORKs aid based on pregnancy. Issue a temporary BIC using the parent's case serial number.

Other Health Coverage (OHC)

Do not report OHC information for children who are applying for minor consent services only, regardless of whether the child's parents have OHC. If the minor has their own coverage through another source, then the OHC must be on the minor's temporary BIC. If a temporary BIC is being issued based on the

parent's Medi-Cal case and an OHC code exists for the minor, submit a MEDS Network On-Line Request form (14-28 HHSA) requesting for the MEDS operator to remove the OHC code. When minor consent services are no longer needed, submit a 14-28 HHSA to have the OHC code added prior to the following month's eligibility in MEDS.

E. Returned BICs

BICs that cannot be delivered by the post office will be returned to DHCS and destroyed. DHCS will report returned BICs via MEDS alerts 9007, 9009, and 9010. BICs that are mailed to a FRC P.O. Box, will be kept in a secure location.

F. General Format of BICs

A Medi-Cal BIC contains information specific to the customer:

- The front of each BIC contains the CIN, date of birth, and the card issuance date. Providers use this information to access AEVS
- The CIN is a state-issued number. It begins with a "9" followed by seven numeric digits, one alpha character, a check digit, and a four-digit code, which is the Julian date for the date of issue
- The issue date on the BIC is the date the card is generated. The issue date can be viewed on the MEDS INXB screen

A request for a replacement BIC will invalidate the previously issued BIC. Previously issued cards cannot be used once a replacement is generated, as the issue date has changed.

Procedures:

Refer to Processing Guide 21 - Benefits Identification Card (BIC) Issuance for instructions on issuing temporary BICs and returning temporary BICs that are not claimed.

Program Impacts:

CalWORKs, Refugee Cash Assistance (RCA), and Foster Care (FC) customers receive their Medi-Cal BICs in accordance with this policy.

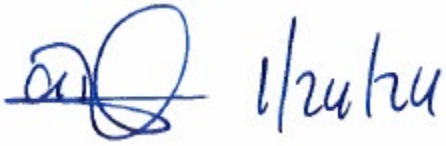
References:

All County Welfare Directors Letter (ACWDL) 94-28.
Title 22, Sections 50737 and 50743.
Medi-Cal Eligibility Procedures Manual (MEPM) 14A and 14B, 19A and 19B.

Sunset Date:

This policy will be reviewed for continuance on or by December 31, 2029.

Approval for Release:



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Self-Sufficiency Services